

JAPANESE CHANOYU

Chanoyu, which translates as “hot water for tea,” is a meditative ritual. Also known as Chado, or “Way of Tea,” it is believed that through performing the ritual motions of tea preparation, it is possible to reach enlightenment.

The purpose of the Chanoyu ceremony is to prepare a simple and pure cup of powdered green tea (Matcha), through prescribed movements using specific teaware and implements. There are two types of tea ceremony. The first, Chakai, which is shown here, is an informal tea meeting that lasts under an hour. Usicha (thin Matcha) is served with Wagashi (sweets) to cut through the bitterness of

the tea. The second, Chaji, is a very formal ceremony lasting four hours, in which Koicha (thick Matcha) is prepared and served alongside an elaborate four-course meal, or “kaiseki”.

Originally a Zen Buddhist ceremony, Chanoyu was refined by tea master, Sen no Rikyu in the 16th century. He outlined the principles of harmony, respect, purity, and tranquility. His tea ceremony practices are still taught around the world.

CHASEN

Carved from a single piece of bamboo, this tea whisk has multiple tines that are curled at the ends.

KENSUI

After the chawan has been rinsed, water is poured in to the kensui, or waste bowl, which is supposed to go unnoticed during the ceremony.

CHAWAN

There are different shaped tea bowls for different seasons – shallow for summer and deep for winter. They are made by hand and have a simple and humble aesthetic known as “wabi”.

FUTA-OKI

When the lid from the tetsubin (kettle) is removed, it is placed on this lid rest, which is made of bamboo.

HISHAKU

A long bamboo ladle used to scoop hot water from the kettle.

CHAKIN

White cloth used ritually to clean the tea bowl.

